Marta Kowal-Brandt

DevOps / Platform Engineering | CI/CD, Kubernetes and Infrastructure Automation
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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

QA automation engineer with 7 years of experience and a strong focus on CI/CD, test infrastructure and build tooling. Owns GitLab CI pipelines and Kubernetes-based ephemeral test environments for three product teams. Experienced in improving delivery pipelines, automating environment lifecycle tasks, and making test systems more observable. Building further infrastructure experience through a personal k3s and GitOps homelab and Terraform practice.

SELECTED INFRASTRUCTURE PROJECTS

Merge-Request Ephemeral Environments | Odrava Health Software | 2023–2024

- Built short-lived environments for each merge request, deploying the application, PostgreSQL and seeded data to a shared Kubernetes cluster using Helm from GitLab CI.
- Automated environment cleanup after merge or 48 hours of inactivity; enabled QA and product reviews before merge and e2e tests against each environment.
- Technologies: GitLab CI, Helm, Kubernetes, Docker, Bash, PostgreSQL.

CI Pipeline Speed-up | Odrava Health Software | 2022

- Profiled pipelines across three teams, parallelised test jobs, added dependency caching and separated e2e testing into its own stage.
- Reduced average pipeline time from 38 to 14 minutes and monthly CI runner cost by about 30%.
- Technologies: GitLab CI, Docker, pytest-xdist.

Homelab k3s Cluster with GitOps | Personal | 2024–2025

- Operated a three-node Raspberry Pi 5 k3s cluster, deploying applications from a Git repository with Argo CD.
- Set up Prometheus, Grafana and Loki monitoring, Traefik ingress and cert-manager for TLS.
- Provisioned infrastructure for a small Hetzner VPS using Terraform; used Ansible at a basic level.
- Technologies: k3s, Argo CD, Prometheus, Grafana, Loki, Terraform, Ansible.

Flaky Test Dashboard | Odrava Health Software | 2023

- Collected CI test results in PostgreSQL and created Grafana dashboards showing flaky tests by team.
- The flaky test rate fell from 7% to below 1% after teams began addressing the top offenders.
- Technologies: Python, PostgreSQL, Grafana, GitLab API.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

DevOps Engineer | Odrava Health Software, Wroclaw | 2021–Present

- Own GitLab CI pipelines for three product teams (approximately 25 developers), covering build, unit, integration and e2e test stages and artifact publishing.
- Built and maintain merge-request test environments using Docker Compose and Helm on the company's shared Kubernetes cluster; have namespace-level access.
- Maintain a pytest and Playwright e2e suite of approximately 900 tests; reduced the flaky test rate from 7% to below 1%.
- Develop Bash and Python tooling for PostgreSQL test-data seeding.
- Wrote the internal "How our CI works" onboarding document and mentored two QA interns in 2023.

QA Engineer | Brightmill Software House, Wroclaw | 2019–2021

- Tested web and mobile applications for client projects using manual and automated approaches.
- Introduced a Selenium and Java automated regression suite for the largest client project.

- Configured Jenkins jobs for nightly regression runs.

Customer Support Specialist (2nd line) | Brightmill Software House | 2018–2019

- Investigated customer issues using logs and databases, and reproduced bugs for developers.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

CI/CD and containers: GitLab CI, Jenkins, Docker, Docker Compose
Infrastructure and orchestration: Kubernetes (namespace-level access to a shared cluster), Helm, k3s, Terraform (personal project), Argo CD, Ansible (basic)
Monitoring and data: Prometheus, Grafana, Loki, PostgreSQL, SQL
Programming and automation: Python, Bash, Java (test code), Git
Cloud exposure: AWS EC2 and S3 fundamentals through personal learning; Hetzner VPS (personal project)
Testing: pytest, Playwright, Selenium, Postman
Operating systems: Linux

EDUCATION

BEng, Computer Engineering | Silesian Lowlands University of Technology | 2018

CERTIFICATIONS AND PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

ISTQB Foundation Level | 2019
Certified Kubernetes Administrator (CKA) exam scheduled for January 2027; currently studying

LANGUAGES

Polish (native), English (C1), German (A2)